

NOVEMBER 16-30, 1979

The demand of Jahan's mother for a CBI inquiry is absolutely justified. The deductions of Magistrate S.P. Tamang and the revelations in the affidavit of the Union Home Ministry do not match and are cryptic, hence these confound the muddle. The voice of human right activists in Gujarat and the agony of an aggrieved mother must be considered to maintain the faith of the people in justice.

INDU SHANKAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Troubled Borders

Bangladesh is a problem for India as many Bangladeshis illegally cross the border and are involved in many illegal activities ("Mending Fences", September 21). Now Nepal is being used to pump fake currency into India. Pakistan and China are other trouble-makers for India. The strained relations with our neighbouring countries demand a stronger diplomatic and defence strategy.

MAHESH KUMAR, *Delhi*

Dangerously Dear

It is a pity that Central and state governments have not taken strong measures to bring down the prices by importing food items or taken action against the blackmarketeers ("Squashed", September 21). Adding fuel to the fire is the Government's claim that inflation has dropped

and economy has improved. The Government must import foodgrains, give more concession to farmers to grow alternative crops and act strongly against hoarders.

R. MURALIKUMAR, *Chennai*

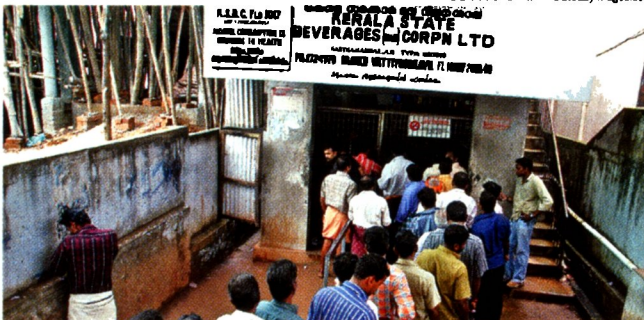
Checking inflation and curbing publicity binges both by the Centre and the Congress-ruled states are important for the UPA. If the ruling coalition fails to check inflation and wasteful

("Judiciary Under Scrutiny", September 7). When all other government offices duly function in summers what is the justification for a long summer vacation in the courts? On the contrary, courts need to work overtime to clear the backlog.

M.C. JOSHI, *Lucknow*

Unfair Laws

An allegation of cruelty by one's wife is enough to land the husband behind bars ("Unhappily Harried",



“Despite subsidies on food and other day-to-day requirements, spending on such items is less compared to the expenditure on liquor. This is indeed tragic.”

MPR PANICKER, via www.indiatoday.in

expenditure, it may find itself in trouble.

R.J. KHURANA, *Bhopal*

The Idea of Justice

With numerous cases pending in the courts across the country, the first step towards judicial reforms needs to be abolishing the British legacy of court vacations

August 31). Many men lose their jobs, not to mention their mental balance, due to the harassment meted out to them by their wives. Exemplary punishment should be given in cases where a complaint using the special laws is proved false or fabricated.

S. BHARADWAJ,
via www.indiatoday.in

Battle for Seats

As hundreds of politicians besiege the national headquarters of the political parties in Delhi for election tickets, the strain is beginning to tell on the various parties which had hastily papered over their cracks with election posters. The Janata Party, which is trying to project itself as a party free from Jan Sangh and Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) pressure, created some heart-burning in its ranks when the first election list of 114 candidates was announced last fortnight. For instance, the names of two prominent and voluble Jan Sangh members, O.P. Tyagi and Hukum Chand Kachwai, from Bahraich in Uttar Pradesh and Ujjain in Madhya Pradesh, have not been included in the list, though the party had earlier announced that all sitting members would be given tickets. Tyagi, the author of the controversial Freedom of Religion Bill, has been ditched to appease the Christian population at the behest of Jagjivan Ram.



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